

updated as files are moved and created. This reduces system performance. Of course, it also speeds up searches, so you should turn it off or keep it on depending on how often you conduct local searches.

To turn off the Windows indexing service, open Windows Explorer, and right-click on each drive and choose 'Properties'. In the 'General' tab, right at the bottom, uncheck the box 'Allow Indexing service to index this ...'. Alternatively, you can completely get rid the indexing service by going to Control Panel > Add or Remove Programs > Windows Components, and then un-checking 'Indexing Service'.



Disabling the Indexing Service altogether

## 6. Disable The Disk Performance Counter(s)

XP comes with many inbuilt performance monitoring applications that constantly examine various parts of the system. This information can be of real use to a system administrator for collecting performance statistics. However, for a home user, these statistics hold no value, and since the monitoring happens all the time, it consumes a good deal of system resources.

"Disk monitoring," for example, happens in the background, and turning it off is advisable if you will not be using the performance monitoring applications. To turn it off, type in "diskperf -N" at a command prompt.

## 7. Moving The 'My Documents' Folder

The 'My Documents' folder invariably ends up as the default repos-